

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1048

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Carmon Thomas Hooper III of Brownsville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Carmon Thomas Hooper III; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Hooper was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hooper was born on January 8, 1931, the first of four sons of Carmon Thomas Hooper, Jr., and Annie Mann Hooper; and

WHEREAS, he attended Haywood County schools before completing his secondary education at Kentucky Military Institute in Lyndon, Kentucky; in 1953, he graduated from the University of Alabama, where he was a member of Delta Kappa Epsilon; and

WHEREAS, following his graduation, Tommy Hooper served his country with honor in the United States Air Force, attaining the rank of First Lieutenant and flying the F-86D interceptor while stationed in Chitose, Japan, during the early years of the Cold War; and

WHEREAS, after completing his military service, Mr. Hooper attended Vanderbilt University School of Law on the G.I. Bill, graduating in 1959, and was admitted to the Tennessee Bar that same year; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Hooper began his legal career with a Brownsville firm founded by Larry Morgan and Alex Gray and, following their deaths in the 1960s, maintained a solo practice for decades, serving generations of Haywood County residents as a trusted and respected "country lawyer"; and

WHEREAS, a dedicated public servant, Mr. Hooper served six years as a member of the Tennessee House of Representatives, fifteen years on the Haywood County Commission, and eighteen years as County Attorney; and

WHEREAS, he was also a leader in the business and civic life of his community, co-founding First Federal Savings and Loan in 1965 and later serving as Chairman of the Board of First State Bank, and he contributed to local development through residential projects in Brownsville; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hooper was a man of deep faith and enduring commitment to his community, a longtime member of the Rotary Club of Brownsville and a Paul Harris Fellow, and he gave generously of his time as an Eagle Scout and Scoutmaster of Troop 70; and

WHEREAS, in 1962, he married the love of his life, Martha Graham Myatt, and together they shared sixty-three years of marriage and were blessed with five children; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Hooper will be remembered for his daily devotional, his steady habits, his love of family, and his enduring presence in the life of Brownsville, where he practiced law for sixty-seven years and became a familiar and respected figure on the Court Square; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his beloved wife, Martha Myatt Hooper, Mr. Hooper is survived by his children, Ashley (Mark) McClure, Allyson (Pat) Proctor, Anne Sanford French, Tom (Collins) Hooper, and Sandy Hooper; his grandchildren, Mary Sanford (Henry) Shepherd, Myatt McClure, McKay Proctor, Anna Proctor, Carmon Proctor, Grace Elizabeth Hawks, Holland Hawks, Graham Hawks, Eads Hooper, Maggie Hooper, and Myatt Hooper; one great-granddaughter, Martha Mae Shepherd; and his brothers, David (Eleanor) Hooper, Sr., and Jeff (Marjorie) Hooper; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his parents and his brother, Jere Hooper; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hooper leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Carmon Thomas Hooper III, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Hooper.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.